

indicated the present arrangement of consulting part-time

hospital. It's really only a minute or so away," he said.

The question, then, seems to be, How much is too much for good health care?

Cohen says sports teach many facts of life

By Johnny Hawkins

Society often labels athletes "jocks," men playing boyish games with their lives instead of facing the hard facts of life.

UT El Paso baseball coach Andy Cohen says, however, that athletics can be a way of life, learning and wisdom.

"I've been into baseball on the professional level now for 45 years, and I've learned many of the basic necessities of life," Cohen said.

What makes the thud of a stick of wood against a speeding sphere, the clasp of the ball in a glove and the race for that diamond-shaped pot of gold enchant a man for his entire life?

"When I first played professional baseball in the late 1920s and 1930s (Great Depression times), a player didn't have a managing agent, many benefits or much pay. It was a rough way to make a living and you had to love the game to stay,"

Cohen said.

Cohen, a native El Pasoan, was graduated from El Paso High in 1921 where he starred as a basketball, baseball and football player. He went to the University of Alabama on a scholarship and again was a three-letter man. But baseball was his first love, and second base his first calling.

In 1925 Cohen finished college and went to play minor league baseball in Waco. That next year the legendary John McGraw of the New York Giants signed him for a one-year stretch.

"McGraw was a strict disciplinarian," Cohen recalls. "I remember once there was a guy at bat with his brother on first base and two outs against their team. The ball was hit to me, and I forfeited the easy out for an attempted double play, with a bad throw.

"After the game, which we lost, McGraw told me, 'Son you are in the major leagues now, and we don't try double plays with two outs'."

Cohen's major league career briefly switched to minor league status when he spent three years at Newark, N.J., then about one year at Buffalo N.Y., followed by one more year with the Giants. Later Cohen was traded to a Minneapolis team for \$25,000 and one man for his longest stint with a single team, nine and a half years.

"I was always traveling during my career, which teaches me so many lessons about people and how to survive in the world today," Cohen said. "I remember watching my brother Syd of the Washington Senators strike out 'Babe' Ruth of the Yankees in Ruth's last American League game.

"Ruth also hit a homer on Syd that day," Cohen added.

One more year of ball playing with the New Orleans Pelicans after the war boosted Cohen's career as a player to 21 years. "My most enterprising lesson in all those years was to learn from sports to never give up at anything," Cohen said.

Being appointed as last minute stand-in for the assistant manager of the Philadelphia Phillies in a 1960 game against the Milwaukee Braves was one of Cohen's most exciting baseball moments. They won 5-4 in ten innings.

He has worked as a trainer, manager and scout for such major league clubs as the Pittsburgh Pirates, Boston Braves, Brooklyn Dodgers and Chicago White Sox.

Cohen has coached the UT El Paso team since 1962. As a basis for his team's education he uses the "fundamentals" and inside baseball tips taught to him by McGraw and the philosophy of sports taught him by Luther Coblenty, his high school coach.

Syd Cohen, the brother who fanned the Sultan of Swat, and who also serves as an assistant to his brother, remembers when



"blacks couldn't participate in baseball with whites so they had their own leagues. Later they changed the rule with the introduction of Jackie Robinson, who stood a lot of stuff just to be able to play."

"In my time the fellows used to be guys who drank beer together after the games, not caring about the little pay. Now baseball is big business," he explained.

Jim Bowden, athletic director, who remembers watching Syd play and had heard of Andy's talent, said, "They are both knowledgeable baseball authorities. Andy is a super guy. He can coach the team for as long as state rules permit."

The aging coach, who declined to give his age for publication, still makes it to practice almost daily to work out with the players.

"He stresses education first then sports interest," Mike Rima, pitcher, said.

"This year's team finds it easier than ever before to take our ideas for improvement to Cohen and have something done about them," Dave Jannusch, co captain said. "Everybody on the team likes and respects Andy and Syd as people and coaches."

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